



How dare you look and anything else?

on Mac, Windows and on Linux and it's large user base ensures that with the right encoders, you can play just about any audio file and make it spit out your project in any format your heart desires.

Audacity is perfect for just about everything. You can record VOs, Podcasts, Music and even record what's playing on your sound card right now.

Here's the basics for when it comes to working with Audacity:

- ▶ Audacity's interface is relatively less crowded and most of your controls are easy to find. On the top left are your record and playback controls and hitting the button with the little red circle inside quickly opens up a new track and you can start recording audio almost immediately.
- ▶ Audacity activates the default input plugged in and starts recording and signals coming in from it so for a more planned approach, go to Tracks> Add New> Audio Track or just hit Ctrl + Shift+ N for a new track.
- ▶ Audacity also allows users to record and mix multiple tracks in one session. Once you're done with your first track, hitting the record button or creating a new tracks will allow you to record a second track. You can either choose to listen to the first track you just recorded for reference or not by hitting the 'Mute' button on the track you want to mute. You can also choose to do away with listening to previous tracks altogether by going to Tracks and unchecking the 'Overdub' option.

The audio you record may not necessarily be of the best quality and there might be a little bit of noise Audacity has a really interesting feature to help reduce it. Start by leaving a little bit of silence before your take. Once your take is done, hit Effects> Noise Removal.

The dialogue box that opens up has an option that says "Get Noise Profile". Click the button and then select the portion of your audio that recorded the noise. Open up the dialogue box once again and take a look at the second half of the box. This gives you options where you can decide how much of the noise needs to be removed and how to go about it.

Under Effects, you also have a whole bunch of options ranging from Amplifying certain frequencies to cutting frequencies, setting upper limits for levels and even do fades.

Once the effects have been applied, you can then merge the tracks to form one single track to make your timeline simpler. You can either select the tracks you're working on go to Tracks and hit Mix and Render or Simply